

Capitals want more self-driving cars

送信者: POLITICO Pro Morning Mobility Europe 受信日時: 2026-07-13 14:01

【要点】

- ・ 4つのEU加盟国（エストニア、ラトビア、リトアニア、スロバキア）が欧州委員会に対し、自動運転車の展開促進を求めており、現在のパイロットプログラム中心のアプローチでは不十分だと主張している。
- ・ 米国と中国ではすでに自動運転タクシーが大規模に運行されており、米国で週45万件、中国で週25万件以上の利用があるのに対し、欧州ではパイロットプログラムに限定されている。
- ・ 欧州のパイロットプログラムでは中国の技術が活用されており、マドリードではUberがWeRideと、ルクセンブルクではBoltがPony.aiと提携するなど、欧州が技術開発で後れを取るリスクがある。
- ・ 各自治体が自動運転規制を個別に実装しているため、複数国にまたがるサービス展開が困難になっており、企業のスケラビリティが阻害されている。
- ・ 欧州委員会は、ライドハイリングサービスと自動運転サービスの統一市場を創設するためのEU域内レベルの規制枠組みを策定する必要がある。

【メール原文】

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure. By TOMMASO LECCA with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO SNEAK PEEK — Four member co

Navigating the complex world of EU mobility policy and infrastructure.

By TOMMASO LECCA

with JORDYN DAHL and MARTINA SAPIO

View in your browser or listen to audio

SNEAK PEEK

— Four member countries want the Commission to take action to get more autonomous vehicles on the road in Europe.

— EasyJet's likely takeover could have different impacts on the European airline market depending on which investment firm wins the race to manage the U.K. low-cost airline.

— The EU's tariffs reduced imports of Chinese-made EVs, but Chinese brands are still gaining market share by adapting their business models.

Good morning, and welcome to Morning Mobility.

Tips to jdahl@politico.eu , tlecca@politico.eu and msapio@politico.eu . Follow us @tommylecca , @jordyndahl and @martsapio .

DRIVING THE DAY

MORE ACTION ON AUTONOMOUS CARS: Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania and Slovakia are calling on the European Commission to do more to get autonomous vehicles on the road. In a letter to the Commission dated June 29 and obtained by POLITICO, the countries say the automotive action plan that set out a roadmap for autonomous cars puts too much focus on pilot programs.

Current status: Autonomous robotaxis already operate at scale in cities across the United States and China. In the U.S., the self-driving taxis account for 450,000 rides per week and over 250,000 a week in China, the letter states. Meanwhile in Europe, autonomous taxis are limited to pilot programs that confine the cars to a particular city or region.

Changing power dynamics: The letter says that the gap is not caused by a “lack of expertise,” arguing that European companies are “globally competitive.” In both the U.S. and China, tech companies are leading the way on ride-hailing, partnering with automakers that use their software in the cars. Industry experts warn that Europe’s tech industry is smaller and less well-funded than in the U.S. and China.

Falling behind: Many of the pilot programs in the EU feature Chinese technology. In Madrid, American ride-hailing platform Uber is partnering with Chinese autonomous driving firm WeRide to launch a pilot program later this year. Europe’s ride-hailing competitor Bolt, meanwhile, is linking up with Chinese software company Pony.ai for a separate pilot in Luxembourg.

The problem: While the EU follows U.N. rules on autonomous driving, it’s up to each municipality to implement such regulations. That is proving to be a headache for companies wanting to launch the taxis at scale, particularly if the cars are expected to cross borders.

What they want: The Commission needs to put forward an “EU-level framework” to create a single market for ride-hailing companies and autonomous driving services. Otherwise, “global competitors with the financial capacity to overcome regulatory constraints will dominate” autonomous driving, pushing out smaller European companies, the letter warns.

AVIATION

IMPACT OF A POTENTIAL EASYJET TAKEOVER: EasyJet could soon change direction after agreeing to consider offers from two takeover suitors. U.S. investment firm Castlelake has offered around £5.2 billion for the British airline, while another U.S. investor, Apollo Global Management, has responded with a £5.7 billion proposal. Both firms now have until early August to formalize their bids or walk away.

Two scenarios: According to aviation industry consultant Linus Benjamin Bauer, easyJet’s future will differ significantly depending on its next owner.

“If Castlelake were to acquire easyJet, I would expect the primary focus to be on unlocking the underlying value of the company’s assets,” Bauer told Tommaso, noting that such an ownership change could involve gradually selling aircraft, airport slots and aircraft order positions. “The medium-term risk would be a gradual reduction in network breadth and capacity,” Bauer said.

By contrast, “Apollo’s approach appears more consistent with a longer-term financial investment,” the expert said. “I would expect Apollo to prioritize improving profitability while preserving easyJet as a functioning airline,” he added, arguing that this would represent the lower-risk scenario for both passengers and employees.

Big winners: If Castlelake wins the race to acquire easyJet, “Europe’s largest airline groups (including Lufthansa Group, IAG and Air France-KLM) would likely be among the biggest beneficiaries,” Bauer said. He suggested the major airline groups could strengthen their positions at big airports while acquiring aircraft that would otherwise take years to receive from manufacturers.

“Ryanair and Wizz Air would also benefit from any reduction in easyJet’s competitive presence, although to a lesser extent because their business models rely more heavily on secondary airports and organic expansion,” Bauer added.

If Apollo prevails, Bauer expects easyJet to maintain its current business model, meaning “the competitive landscape would remain broadly unchanged.”

No crisis for low-cost aviation: Bauer said that easyJet’s sale doesn’t mean that the low cost model is in trouble. The British carrier, he said, “owns valuable aircraft, holds scarce slots at Europe’s most capacity-constrained airports, has an attractive aircraft order book and has built a profitable holidays business,” making it an attractive acquisition target.

The broader challenge, however, is that “aircraft delivery delays, higher financing costs, labour shortages and infrastructure constraints have fundamentally changed the economics of expansion,” Bauer said — pressures that affect the entire European airline industry.

CARS

CHINA’S EV PUSH SURVIVES EU TARIFFS: The EU’s tariffs reduced imports of Chinese-made EVs, but Chinese brands continued to gain market share by adapting their business models, according to a new analysis by green NGO Transport & Environment.

The numbers: EVs made in China accounted for 17 percent of the EU battery electric vehicle market in the first quarter of 2026, down from 22 percent in 2024 when the tariffs were introduced. The decline was largely driven by Tesla, BMW and Volvo relocating production to Europe, while Chinese manufacturers now account for more than half of all Chinese-built EV imports into the EU.

Not all tariffs are equal: T&E says Chinese manufacturers responded differently depending on their tariff rates. SAIC, facing a 35 percent duty, nearly halved its EU EV exports between 2023 and 2025, while BYD, subject to a 17 percent tariff, more than doubled its shipments. Chinese brands have also accelerated plans to build factories in Europe and expanded sales of plug-in hybrids, which are not covered by the EU’s EV tariffs.

Battery loophole: While Brussels targeted electric cars, imports of Chinese batteries — which face almost no tariffs — increased sevenfold between 2020 and 2025, according to the report. T&E argues the EU should extend trade defense measures to batteries, estimating that a 20 percent tariff would increase the price of EU-made electric cars by just 2.8 percent on average.

What’s next: The NGO also warns that weakening the EU’s 2030 and 2035 car CO2 targets would hand Chinese manufacturers an even bigger advantage. Under proposals to soften the rules, Chinese brands could capture 30 percent of the bloc’s EV market by 2035, compared with 15 percent under the Commission’s current plans.

VW-TRANSFORMATION: Volkswagen announced “the next phase of its transformation” in a press release on Friday, but CEO Oliver Blume did not confirm any speculation on job cuts or closing factories. Previous reports suggested the carmaker might cut 100,000 to 120,000 jobs in the next

years.

Fewer cars, fewer models: VW confirmed it will produce fewer cars in the future, expecting an output of 9 million cars per year and planning to halve its model range, our colleague Ferdinand Knapp reports.

Plants in limbo: Questions still remain over the future of Volkswagen's underutilized plants. Previous reports suggested the Osnabrück plant could be repurposed for military vehicle production .

MARITIME

EU REMAINS RUSSIA'S LNG LIFELINE: The EU paid an estimated €5.96 billion for LNG from Russia's Yamal Arctic project in the first half of 2026, with Europe receiving 97 percent of all cargoes shipped from the facility, according to new analysis by German NGO Urgewald out today.

The numbers: Between January and June, Yamal shipped 140 cargoes globally, of which 136 were delivered to EU ports. France, Belgium and Spain remained the biggest buyers, while China received just four cargoes during the six-month period. Compared with the first half of 2025, EU imports from Yamal rose 16 percent by volume, while deliveries to Asia fell 84 percent.

More than a customer: Urgewald argues Europe has become the logistical backbone of Russia's flagship Arctic LNG project. Because Yamal's specialized Arc7 ice-class tankers rely on quick turnarounds at European ports during the Arctic winter, the NGO says Europe's role extends beyond buying gas to keeping the export operation running.

Fayard back in focus: The report also renews pressure on Denmark's Fayard shipyard, which Urgewald says remains the last EU yard servicing the Arc7 vessels before the bloc's ban on maritime services for Russian LNG ships enters into force in January. Campaigners argue that servicing the vessels now extends the operational life of the fleet transporting Russian LNG.

The ask: Urgewald is urging Brussels to go beyond next year's maritime services ban by ending Russian LNG imports altogether.

HORMUZ SHUTDOWN FEARS RETURN: The Strait of Hormuz plunged back into crisis over the weekend after an Iranian attack on a container ship triggered a new round of U.S. strikes on Iran, prompting Tehran to declare the waterway closed.

A container ship was struck on Sunday, according to the UK Maritime Trade Operations .

PIT STOPS

A man was nearly sucked out of a cabin window during a Ryanair flight when the window shattered six minutes after the plane's departure from Thessaloniki, Greece.

Belgium unveiled plans for a road toll for passenger cars on highways and regional roads from May.

This email alert has been sent for your exclusive use as a POLITICO Pro subscriber. Forwarding or reproducing the newsletter without the express, written permission of POLITICO Pro is a violation of the POLITICO Pro license agreement.

This email was sent to shondo@iies.co.jp

[Update settings](#) | [Unsubscribe from this email](#) | [Unsubscribe from all emails](#)

POLITICO SRL · Rue de la Loi 62 · Brussels 1040 · Belgium